

Could the U.S. Have Saved Navalny?



REVIEW

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

Outsmart The 'Fall Fashion' Mayhem

OFF DUTY



What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **The Trump** administration is preparing to sell stock in mortgage giants Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac in an offering it believes could raise \$30 billion, according to people familiar with the matter. **A1**

◆ **Trump's team** is reviewing new contenders to be the next chairman of the Federal Reserve, according to senior administration officials. **A1**

◆ **Meta** has settled a defamation lawsuit with a conservative activist who alleged the company's AI chatbot falsely asserted he participated in the 2021 riot at the U.S. Capitol. **B9**

◆ **The stock market** rallied on Friday. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow rose 0.8%, 1% and 0.5%, respectively. **B10**

◆ **U.K. antitrust officials** said they wouldn't open an in-depth probe into Boeing's deal to acquire fuselage maker Spirit AeroSystems. **B9**

◆ **Disney** has reached a settlement with actress Gina Carano over a lawsuit alleging she was wrongfully fired from "The Mandalorian" over her social-media posts. **B9**

◆ **GSK** said it would receive \$370 million as part of a U.S. patent settlement between CureVac and BioNTech related to messenger mRNA-based Covid-19 vaccines. **B9**

World-Wide

◆ **Russia's Putin** presented the Trump administration with a sweeping proposal for a cease-fire in Ukraine, demanding major territorial concessions by Kyiv, according to European and Ukrainian officials. **A1**

◆ **As a record number** of people in the U.S. are sickened with measles, researchers are resurrecting the search for treatments. **A3**

◆ **Trump removed** former congressman Billy Long as IRS commissioner. **A2**

◆ **The Trump administration** is seeking a \$1 billion settlement from UCLA. **A3**

◆ **The administration** is warning Harvard that it could take over its patents, worth hundreds of millions of dollars, if a review finds it hasn't complied with federal law. **A3**

◆ **Trump has directed** the Pentagon to prepare options to use military force against Latin American drug cartels, according to a senior U.S. official. **A6**

◆ **The Justice Department** is intensifying its pursuit of some of the president's most vocal Democratic critics. **A4**

◆ **Israel's decision** to expand the war in Gaza drew expressions of concern from allies and hostage families. **A8**

◆ **Died: James Lovell**, 97, commander of Apollo 13. **A4**

◆ **William H. Webster**, 101, former head of FBI and CIA. **A4**

NOONAN AI is here, and a quiet havoc has begun **A13**

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Vance Mixes Business and Bonding on U.K. Trip



FISHIN' BUDDIES: Vice President JD Vance and U.K. Foreign Secretary David Lammy tried their luck Friday at a lake at Lammy's official country residence in Kent, England. Vance's visit will be followed by family vacations in the Cotswolds and Scotland. **A9**

Trump Tees Up Fannie, Freddie Offering

Deal to sell shares in the mortgage giants could raise about \$30 billion this year

The Trump administration is preparing to sell stock in mortgage giants Fannie Mae and Freddie Mac in an offering it believes could raise around \$30 billion and kick off later this year, according to people familiar with the matter.

By Corrie Driebusch, AnnaMaria Andriotis and Gina Heeb

The plans being discussed by some administration officials could value the companies at roughly \$500 billion or more combined and involve selling between 5% and 15% of their stock, some of the people said. Still up for debate is whether the mortgage giants would go public as one company or two separate entities.

Fannie and Freddie, which bundle and sell mortgages, have been under government control since the 2008 financial crisis and rely on a government-backed guarantee to protect investors from losses. Shares of the firms, which currently trade on over-the-counter markets, each closed up roughly 20% after The Wall Street Journal reported on the offering plans.

It is unclear whether Fannie and Freddie would remain under government conservatorship. *Please turn to page A4*

Putin Will Halt War If He Gets Eastern Ukraine, He Tells U.S.

Russian President Vladimir Putin presented the Trump administration this past week with a sweeping proposal for a cease-fire in Ukraine, demanding major territorial concessions by Kyiv—and a push for global recognition of its claims—in exchange for a halt to the fighting, according to European and Ukrainian officials.

European officials expressed serious reservations about the proposal, which

would require Ukraine hand over its eastern region known as the Donbas, without Russia committing to much other

By Bojan Pancevski in Berlin and Alexander Ward and Robbie Gramer in Washington

than to stop fighting. The offer, which Putin conveyed Wednesday to U.S. special envoy Steve Witkoff in Moscow,

set off a diplomatic scramble to get further clarity on details of the proposal.

President Trump said on social media that he would meet with Putin next Friday in Alaska. He didn't provide additional information about the meeting. The Kremlin didn't respond to a request for comment.

Trump said on Wednesday the Russian leader's offer wasn't a breakthrough but was

enticing enough to begin organizing a summit meeting. The proposal could signal a shift away from Russia's previous demands for full Russian control of regions along the entire front line, which extends beyond the Donbas.

European and Ukrainian officials, who were briefed by *Please turn to page A7*

◆ **Russian oil vulnerability** goes only so far..... **A7**

New Names Join List of Fed Chair Contenders

By BRIAN SCHWARTZ AND NICK TIMIRAO

WASHINGTON—President Trump's team is reviewing new contenders to be the next chairman of the Federal Reserve, with a longtime economic consultant and a past Fed president added to the list, according to senior administration officials.

The Fed chair candidates include former St. Louis Fed President James Bullard; Marc Sumerlin, a former economic adviser to President George W. Bush; National Economic Council director Kevin Hassett; Fed governor Christopher Waller; and former Fed governor Kevin Warsh, the officials said. Bullard and Sumerlin are two of the possible nominees added to a list of about 10 people under consideration for the job, the officials said.

Trump is turning to Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent to lead the search for the next chairman, according to the officials. Bessent will conduct the initial interviews with all of the candidates and will then recommend a final list of possible choices, who will then meet with Trump, the officials said. Trump has said other top advisers would also be involved in the process.

Bessent is now positioned to be a crucial player in the search for the next Fed chair. *Please turn to page A2*

◆ **Fed board pick Miran** sees tariffs as positive..... **A2**

EXCHANGE



REESE'S VS. OREO
Combining two of America's favorite treats sounded simple. It wasn't. **B1**

In U.S.-China Trade Rivalry, Apple's Bet on India Pays Off

CEO Tim Cook looked beyond China to assemble iPhones

By TRIPTI LAHIRI, YANG JIE AND ROLFE WINKLER

SRIPERUMBUDUR, India—Dozens of women wearing ID badges streamed from their rooms in a year-old dormitory for Foxconn workers and headed to a company cafeteria on a recent day for a menu of lentil-and-vegetable stew, beetroot and rice.

White buses waited outside to ferry them to a factory where the Apple contractor builds iPhones.

Women working on assembly lines in India form the backbone of a strategy Apple Chief Executive Tim Cook set in motion years ago. He first looked to boost Apple's position in India's growing smartphone

market after sales in China slowed. Those early steps now leave Apple well-positioned for the intensifying trade rivalry between the U.S. and China.

A year after a 2016 meeting between Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Cook, the company began assembling iPhones in India on a relatively small scale. Apple next pushed suppliers to develop India as an alternative manufacturing hub when President Trump in his first term threatened tariffs on Chinese-made iPhones and, later, when the pandemic slowed iPhone production in China.

The company saw India as the only country outside of China that could assemble *Please turn to page A10*

Stocks Show Health Of America's Vices

By LAURA COOPER

Want to know what guilty pleasures are gaining and losing popularity in America? Take a look at the stock prices of Molson Coors and Altria.

Marlboro cigarette-maker Altria, which also owns the growing on! nicotine pouch, is up nearly 23% so far this year. Shares of Molson Coors, the brewer behind beer brands such as Miller Lite and Blue Moon, are down nearly 12%.

Companies that traditionally sold cigarettes are seeing new engines of growth, no tobacco or smoking required. Nicotine pouches like on! and British American Tobacco's Velo look like tiny tea bags

that sit between the gum and the cheek and are often filled with wood pulp along with nicotine salts and flavorings. The nicotine is absorbed into the bloodstream through the mouth's lining.

Zyn, which is produced by Swedish Match North America, an affiliate of Philip Morris International, is the most popular nicotine pouch. It gained popularity due in part to a devoted following of unaffiliated "Zynfluencers" who tout their love of the brand.

Earlier this year, U.S. health officials authorized Zyn to stay on the market after finding that it has benefits as an *Please turn to page A6*

